

# Bottle, strength and pack: what India accepts

*The format decisions, settled. Final confirmation for your brand happens at state label registration, which we file together in Phase 2.*

## 01 THE BOTTLE · SIZES

**The Indian grid.** Retail runs on 750 ml (the anchor), 375 ml and 180 ml. Duty-free runs 1,000 ml.

**Who decides.** There is no single national rule: pack sizes for alcohol are approved state by state at label registration, under each state's excise rules.

**700 ml.** The EU standard is not part of the default Indian grid. Some states will register 700 ml for bottled-in-origin imports; many will not. Treat it as a state-by-state exception, never as the plan.

## 02 THE STRENGTH · ABV

**The law.** FSSAI's spirits standards recognise tequila by name and permit 31 to 55% alcohol by volume at 20 C, with a tolerance of plus or minus 3% on the declared strength.

**The convention.** Domestic Indian spirits pour at 42.8%; imported premium spirits pour at 40%. On an Indian shelf, 40% reads as international premium.

**The 38% question.** Legal, and in states that tax by proof litre it carries slightly less duty than 40%. Treat it as a state-specific duty play, not a brand identity.

## 03 THE PACK · MATERIAL

**Glass.** The default, and frictionless in every state and channel.

**Ceramic.** Permitted; ceramic tequila already sells in Indian travel retail and gifting. Requirements: food-grade container compliance and the pack registered exactly as sold. Budget the freight.

**The sticker zone.** India adds a rear over-label, MRP stickers and, in several states, security holograms on the closure. Leave clear rear surface and a standard capsule; unusual shapes complicate this.

## 04 THE CASE · SECONDARY PACK

**The carton.** Twelve 750 ml bottles per case is the working standard buyers quote in. Confirm your case weight and dimensions; they drive freight and the CIF quote in File 05.

**Barcodes.** EAN-13 on bottle and case is expected by modern trade. If your codes are US UPC only, plan the addition now.

**Gift boxes.** Boxed reposado and anejo earn their space in the festive quarter; they also add weight and customs value. Cost them as their own SKU.

### THE RULE OF THUMB

750 ml, 40%, glass travels everywhere. Everything else is possible, but it is a state-by-state decision we take together at label registration.